



vismaya kalike

What is the problem?

- The education system as it stands is designed to produce knowledge and skills that AI will replace.
- This will disproportionately affect marginalised communities and children and exacerbate existing inequities.

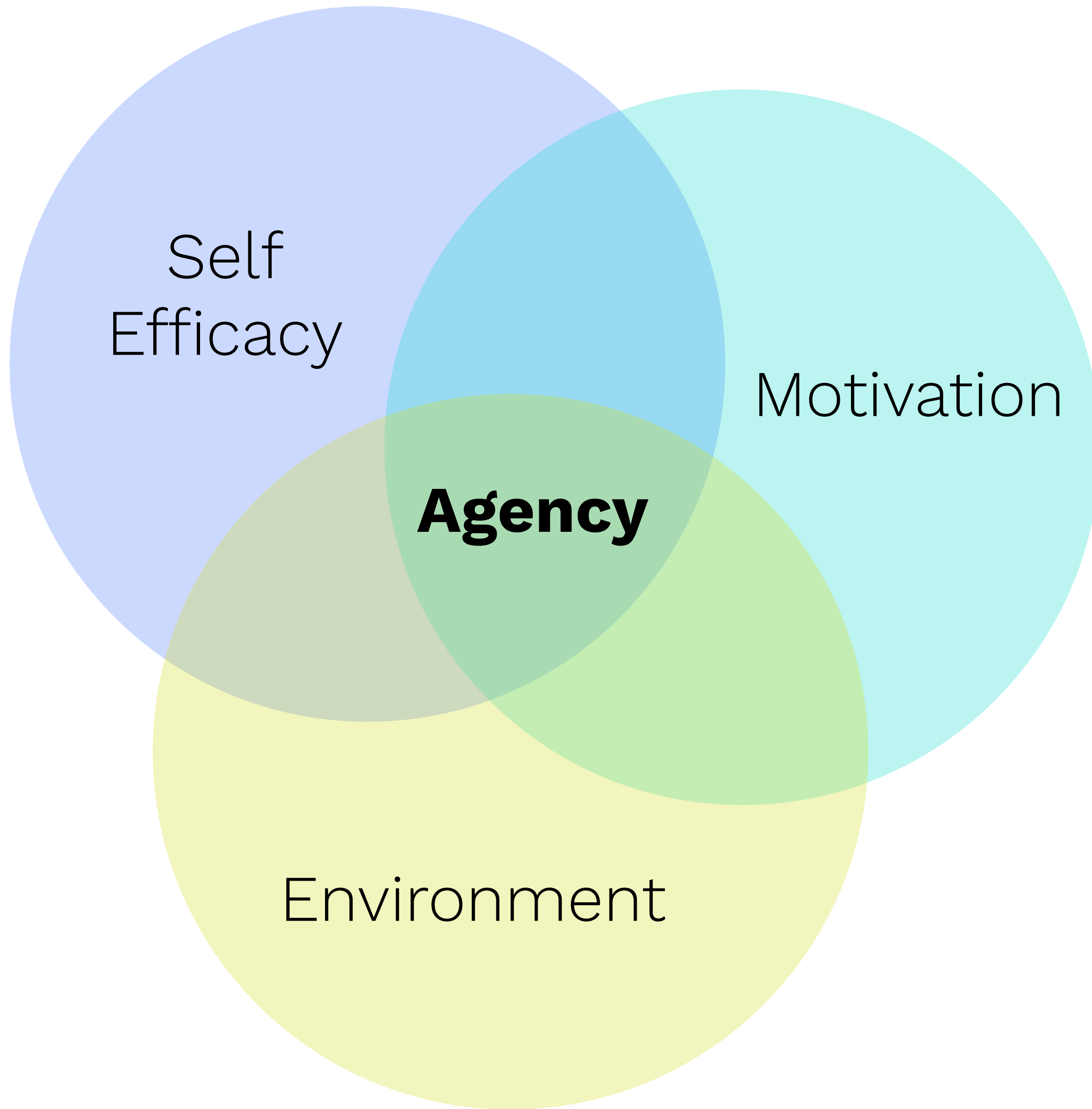


So how do we solve this?

Most of the latest research suggests that building agency in children is key and we tend to agree.

While most initiatives are focused on FLN and basic skills for the marginalised we think that it's important that our programmes look beyond and think about the future.





What exactly is agency?

We have defined agency as the ability of an individual to meaningfully influence their world.



What is Vismaya Kalike?

We think the best way to develop agency is to practice it. So at Vismaya Kalike we create

open, self-determined, joyful

learning spaces in marginalised communities allowing learners to decide what, how and why to learn.



How does it work?

Each learning centre is situated **within the community** and is stocked with plenty of games, books and learning material. The children come to the centre in the evening and choose what they want to work on. The centers are supported by **facilitators** from the community.



How is this different from school?

Unlike school our environments ask children to take **ownership** of their learning. Aside from this we are also **community centric** so children can feel a sense of belonging. Having a local youth as a role model and a space that they're familiar with increases participation and confidence of the **most marginalised** children





What is the theory of change?

STAGE 1 - 2017 to 2025

Co-create safe and joyful learning environments where children can make decisions for themselves

Supporting learners financially and otherwise to progress through current education systems

Developing and identifying learning material and facilitator workshops that can enable such spaces to thrive

STAGE 2 - 2025 to 2030

Dialogue with schools, community leaders and parents to learn from each other and work together

Collaborating with other organisations and sharing learning through online courses and other such mechanisms

Creating a fellowship program to create community education leaders

STAGE 3 - 2030 and beyond

Implementing, advising and executing district, state or national level programmes keeping in mind the learning at the previous levels

Raising awareness about the importance of agency at both the community level and the general public

Advocacy for policy change through collaboration with other stakeholders in the education ecosystem

IMPACT

All children are able to define and enjoy their learning journeys in self determined environments.

Every child develops holistically and is suitably prepared to thrive in the future

Education system reduces inequities of society rather than perpetuate them

What is the progress so far?

- We have established 50 learning centres along with partner organisations across supporting 2000+ children
- Conducted facilitator training and workshops across South India for 150+ teachers
- Apart from our learning centres we have also supported over 100 students with scholarships with over 75 lakh rupees contributed



How do you measure progress?

We measure progress qualitatively through a tech dashboard which aggregates data from the following sources

- Learner portfolios
- Facilitator field notes
- Coordinator reports
- Before-after case studies
- Parents and community feedback





What are some success stories?

- Sujatha, a student from the nearby government Kannada school joined our centre 7 years ago. She is now in 2nd Year B.Com and intends to pursue CA. She is also actively working with the younger children at the centre and supporting the facilitator.
- Neeraj came to our centre 7 years ago seeking help for his 10th grade board exams. He's working now in the finance sector and recently came back to the centre to show us his newly purchased car :)
- Suhana joined our centre two years ago as a restless girl in 5th standard who could not sit in one place. She struggled with the basic alphabet and constantly swore and bullied others. Today, she comfortably reads small stories and helps welcome new children to the centre explaining them the norms of the space.



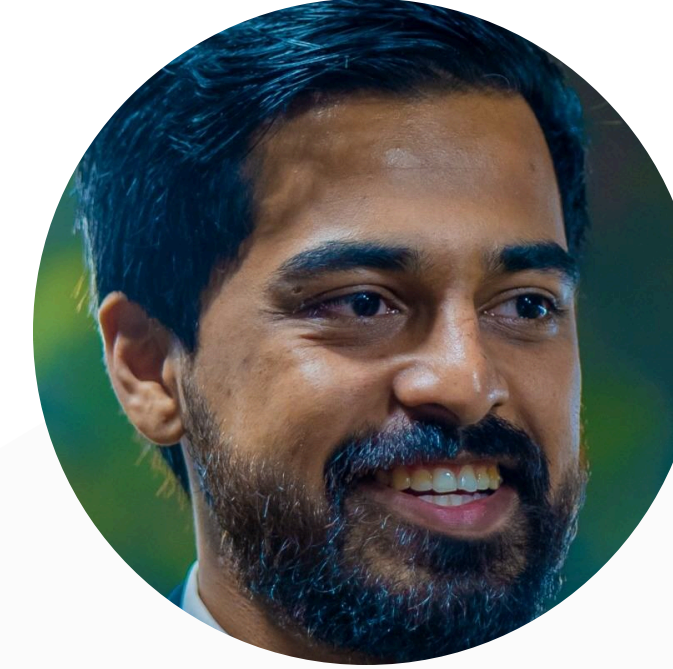
Who is the team?



Srilakshmi Santosh



Venkatesh Naik



Vignesh Prasad



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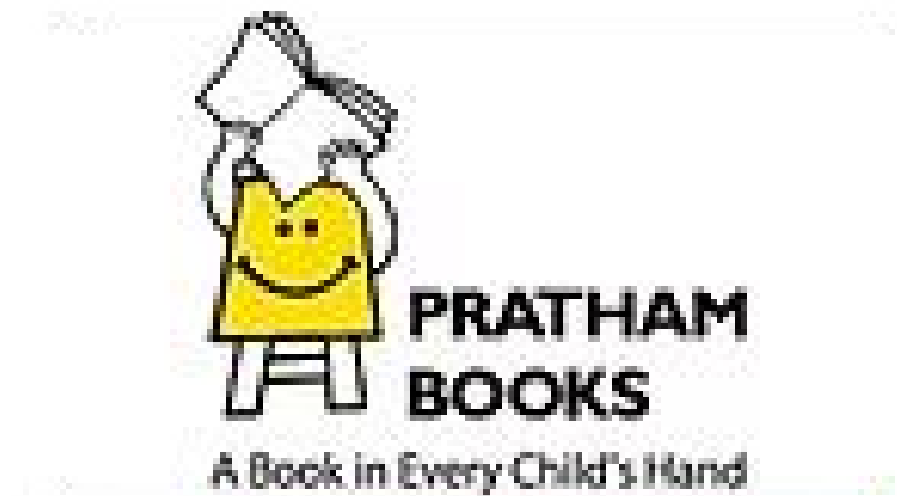
M Gurumoorthy



Janaki Prasad



Who are partners?



What's next?

- 100 learning centres across South India
- Community education fellowship
- Research focus
- Online courses and modules
- Continued scholarship support



What is the budget?

Vismaya Kalike costs as little as
₹25,000
per month to run one center.

This cost is used to cover facilitator honorarium, stationery, rent, learning material etc.



How to contribute?

Our dream of a 100 centers is not possible without your support. We value contributions however small and big but urge you to contribute on a regular basis.

Vismaya Kalike is supported by

India - Heera Foundation

Registered Public Charitable Trust having approval u/s 80G of the Income tax Act 1961

Contribute at:
vismayakalike.org/donate

US - Spring Foundation

A registered public charity in the United States having an EIN number of 32-0826727

Contribute at:
springfnd.org/vika.html

The background of the slide is a collage of several photographs. At the top, there's a photo of a group of people outdoors with trees in the background. On the right side, there's a vertical photo of a woman wearing a pink hijab. At the bottom, there's a photo of a group of smiling children, some wearing blue and white sports jerseys. The central text is overlaid on a white rectangular area.

How to get in touch?

You can reach out to any of our team members

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